FREE BOOK CLUB KIT

Friendly Facilitation Tips

Hosting a discussion is not lecturing — it's keeping a good fire lit in every part of the room.

Keep it warm

- ☐ **One-sentence check-in first.** "How's your week in one sentence?" This gets everyone's voice in the air.
- ☐ **Ask before the debate starts.** Early questions like favorite character lower the stakes.
- ☐ **Thank the picker out loud.** Risk is hospitality in disguise.
- ☐ **Let people pass.** Silence is a member privilege, not a sin.
- ☐ **The moved-reader rule:** when a chapter lands hard on someone, pause the agenda. That's the club working.

Keep it moving

- ☐ **Count to three** before jumping in when the room goes quiet.
- ☐ **Rephrase dead questions.** Turn "what do you think of the plot?" into a choice: "chapter 9 or chapter 3 — which hurt more?"
- ☐ **Seed the quiet people** with a low-stakes question each half of the night.
- ☐ **Track the rambler gently:** "circle back!" works; a sticky note works better.
- ☐ **Save the last 10 minutes** for: next pick, next host, and a shared favorite passage.

If things go sideways

- ☐ **The argument heats up** — return everyone to the text: "show us the page."
- ☐ **Nobody read the book** — pivot: read one great passage aloud and compare notes as a text-free crowd.
- ☐ **One voice ate the night** — go around the room; each person gets to use the floor for one minute.
- ☐ **The book was a dud** — good! The best arguments are born there. Hatred with reasons is still conversation.

The secret: you are not hosting a debate. You are hosting snacks with a prompt. If two people argued kindly, one person laughed, and nobody is lonely this week, the book club has done its job.